

## For those who came in late, a little bit about OSS

Ironically, free and open source software (OSS) was the norm when IBM first started selling computers in the early 1960s. The price of the hardware included the software, and almost all of the latter was bundled with the source code to boot. This meant that the earliest computer software could in fact be modified and collaborated upon. However, this was borne out of necessity – compatibility was often an issue, and since software security mechanisms were rare, users were understandably mistrustful of closed source software.

Soon, though, the cost of software development started to rise due to increasingly sophisticated operating systems and programming languages. Licensed, paid, closed source software became commonplace by the early 1980s.

However, there were individuals who believed that modifying and redistributing software were fundamental rights that shouldn't be taken away. In 1983, Richard Stallman quit MIT's AI lab and launched the GNU project, a mass collaboration project for open and free software that exists to this day. He went on to found the Free Software Foundation (FSF) in 1985 to further support the free software community. Only a few years later in 1991, Linus Torvalds, a Finnish computer science student, began to implement a rudimentary version of what we today know as the Linux operating system.

The GNU Public Licence (GPL) ensured that all software by GNU would be free (libre) and promoted the development of free software.

The rest, as they say, is history.

## OSS today

Android – Google's smartphone operating system – was released in 2008 as open source. Based on the Linux kernel, the OS has been taken up by many smartphone companies around the world and modified (with varying results) by each of them. Google also uses an unmodified version of Android ("vanilla Android") in its Nexus line of smartphones. Today, Android is the most popular smartphone platform in the world. "Android One" is an Android standard aimed at developing countries. Google provides OEMs with a reference hardware design with the aim of manufacturing cheap smartphones running nearly-stock Android. Android One handsets were first released in 2014.

Linus Torvalds created Git – an open source distributed version control system (DVCS) – in 2005, because he was dissatisfied with the other open